



Tinotenda M Madzunguruse, Sommelier

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LANGUAGES

English

SKILLS

FOH + sales
performance: upselling
wines/merchandise,
driving conversions,
supporting revenue
targets

Organisational & budget
discipline: inventory
control, stock availability,
daily cash-ups, sales
reporting

Guest experience
excellence: personalised
tastings, customer
relationship building,
dispute resolution

Wine expertise: strong
product knowledge,
confident pairing
guidance and wine
education

Inventory Management:
Skilled in maintaining
and managing stock levels
to ensure operational
efficiency.

Communication and
Storytelling: Capable of
engaging guests with
compelling stories about
wines, their origins, and
production methods.

PROFILE

Target-driven Sommelier with strong wine knowledge, food and wine pairing capability, proven success in front-of-house service and sales-led environments across luxury hospitality, wine estates, and cruise operations. Experienced in staff scheduling, customer experience leadership, inventory and cash controls, wine club management, events execution, and performance reporting. Known for respectful, positive interaction that creates standout guest experiences while maintaining and growing sales targets.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sommelier, Cunard Cruiseline (Queen Victoria)

Jul 2025 — Feb 2026

- Deliver premium wine service and pairing recommendations across luxury dining venues and bars, maintaining Cunard guest standards.
- Drive beverage revenue through strategic upselling of wines, spirits, cocktails, digestifs and drinks packages aligned to targets.
- Promote and sell Cunard Wine Academy experiences: Lunch & Learn, wine tastings, and curated gourmet pairing dinners.
- Host guest-facing wine sessions using engaging storytelling around varietals, regions, tasting profiles, and service etiquette.
- Support daily service across breakfast/lunch/dinner including hot beverages and bar service during peak periods.
- Manage venue stock control: ensure inventory accuracy, coordinate orders via onboard stores/provisions, and maintain stock rotation.

Sommelier, Bartinney Private Cellar

Aug 2024 — Jun 2025

- Hosted structured tastings and tours, translating terroir, winemaking style, and sustainability into clear guest-friendly storytelling.
- Increased direct sales through preference-based recommendations, driving bottle sales and wine club sign-ups.
- Delivered private experiences (cellar tours, pairing dinners, group tastings), coordinating logistics and service execution.
- Supported tasting room performance by coaching junior staff on product knowledge, service standards, and upselling.
- Maintained operational readiness: stock levels, glassware standards, and tasting room/cellar presentation.

Sommelier, MERTIA

Dec 2023 — Jul 2024

- Implemented beverage inventory controls and strengthened stock management across service periods.

- Enhanced the wine list and delivered high-impact food-and-wine pairing guidance to elevate guest experience and sales.
- Developed staff wine education to improve recommendation confidence, upselling, and service consistency.
- Ensured compliance with alcohol service regulations and responsible service standards.

Tasting Room Manager (Contract), Constantia Uitsig Wine Estate

May 2023 — Nov 2023

- Managed daily tasting room operations to deliver smooth, premium FOH service and consistent guest experience.
- Owned inventory management: maintained optimal stock levels, ensured uninterrupted availability, and supported efficient replenishment.
- Built strong customer relationships and delivered personalised tasting experiences, improving loyalty and repeat visits.
- Drove revenue through upselling wines and merchandise and actively curating tasting options to increase conversion.
- Completed daily cash-ups and ensured accurate handling and reconciliation of financial transactions.
- Led staff scheduling for casual team members to optimise coverage for peak trading periods and events.
- Planned and executed wine-related activations/events to strengthen brand presence and elevate the farm experience.
- Managed the wine club programme (memberships, shipments, and member events) to keep engagement high.
- Produced sales reports and trend analysis to identify top-selling products and support data-driven decisions.

Wine Steward, Muratie Wine Estate

Dec 2019 — May 2023

- Drove a remarkable 25% increase in wine club sign-ups since joining the tasting room team.
- Successfully improved the buying rate ratio per visitor in the tasting room, resulting in increased sales and revenue.
- Utilized effective sales techniques and persuasive communication skills to encourage guests to make purchases.
- Implemented strategic up-selling and cross-selling strategies to maximize the value of each customer transaction.

EDUCATION

Cape Wine Academy, Certificate in Wine

Oct 2021, Stellenbosch

Wine and Spirit Educational Trust (WSET), Level 2

Oct 2021

IU International University of Applied Sciences, Bachelors in Business and IT

Dec 2021 — Nov 2024

Nexford University , Financial Accounting(Course)

Nov 2025 — Jan 2026